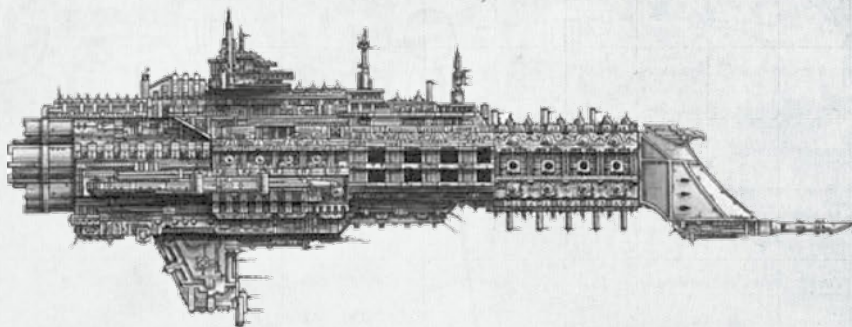


DICTATOR CLASS CRUISER

220 PTS

Famous Ships of the Gothic War: Archon Kort, Fortitude, Rhadamanthine



TYPE/HITS	SPEED	TURNS	SHIELDS	ARMOUR	TURRETS
Cruiser/8	20 cm	45°	2	6+ front / 5+	3
ARMAMENT		RANGE/SPEED		FIREPOWER/STR	FIRE ARC
Port launch bays		Furies: 30 cm Starhawks: 20 cm		2 squadrons	–
Starboard launch bays		Furies: 30 cm Starhawks: 20 cm		2 squadrons	–
Port weapons battery		30 cm		6	Left
Starboard weapons battery		30 cm		6	Right
Prow torpedoes		30 cm		6	Front

Dictator class cruisers are built around Lunar class hulls, with the lance decks entirely rebuilt into launch bays for attack craft. This stop-gap measure was originally undertaken as a simple method of delivering large numbers of atmospheric craft, like the Thunderbolt fighter and Marauder bomber, to low orbit, for ground support operations. However, successive upgrades to the Dictator's communications and detection systems expanded its capabilities for launching long-range strikes against ships in deep space. They were increasingly equipped with Fury class deep space fighters and Starhawk bombers and operated as fleet support vessels and independent patrol ships throughout the Sector. A single Dictator with a handful of escorts proved an exceedingly flexible force capable of running down pirates and raiding hostile worlds with waves of attack craft. Of particular note was the *Rhadamanthine* which, in concert with the Skargul patrol, scored a series of spectacular successes against pirates in the Orar sub sector. During the Gothic War Dictators proved invaluable for escorting convoys of vulnerable transport ships through areas threatened by Chaos ships. As the demand for supporting attack craft in major actions grew, a number of badly damaged Lunar class cruisers were reconfigured as Dictators at the main fleet bases. By the end of the war, seven more Dictators were in service, more than compensating for the loss of the *Rhadamanthine* and *Archon Kort* to Abaddon's fleets.

FLEET LISTS

Gothic Sector Fleet List (pg. 33), Bastion Fleets List (pg. 34),
Armageddon Sector Fleet List (pg. 38), Adeptus Mechanicus Fleet List (pg. 122)